

PASO · SPANISH FOR "STEP"

PASO

Every step counts.

A newcomer's past schooling, turned into a starting point they can stand on.



THE STORY

MEET ANA.

16

years old

GUATEMALA

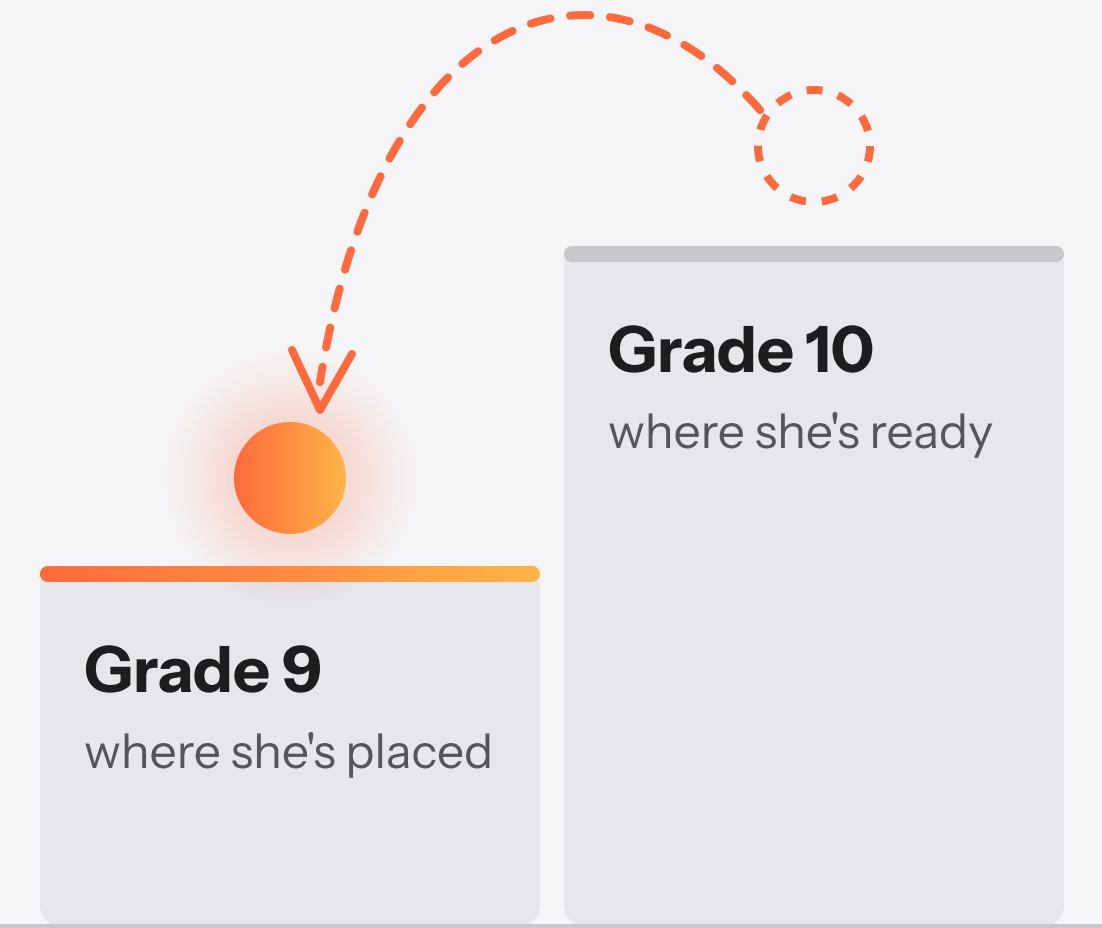
just arrived

9TH GRADE

already finished

In Massachusetts, she's put back in ninth grade, because no one can tell what her transcript counts for.

Ana is a composite, drawn from patterns in Massachusetts newcomer research.



THE EVIDENCE

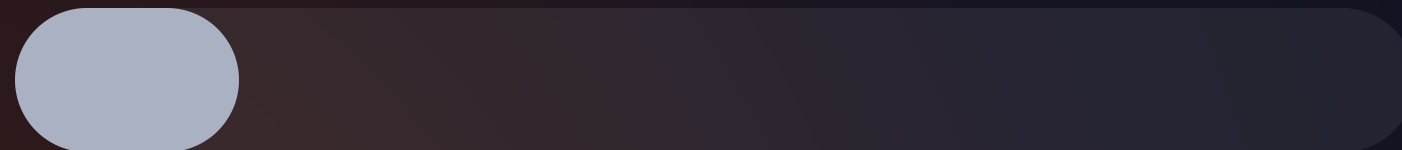
WHERE SHE ENROLLS DECIDES WHERE SHE STARTS.

Springfield



64%

Boston



16%

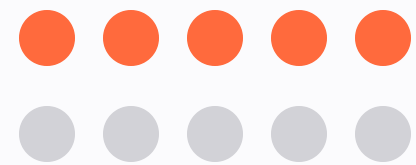
Share of older newcomers (ages 16–18) placed in 9th grade. Bars drawn to scale.

38

point gap remains after
adjusting for
differences between
students.

THE STAKES

OLDER NEWCOMERS HAVE LITTLE TIME TO RECOVER FROM A WRONG START.



1 IN 2

Massachusetts high-school newcomers arrive at 16 or older.



54%

of newcomers graduated from high school, before the pandemic.

THE SCALE

ANA IS NOT ALONE.

1,070,113

immigrant children and youth in U.S. schools who arrived within the last three school years (2021–22).



1 in 6

students entering urban Massachusetts high schools is a newcomer

355

local refugee resettlement sites, run by ten national agencies (2024)

45M

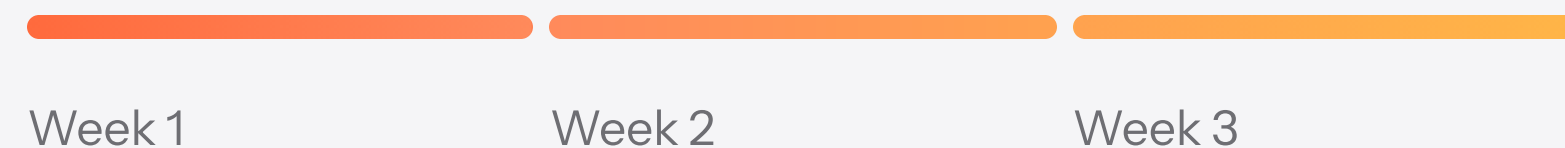
forcibly displaced children worldwide, end of 2025

Sources: U.S. Dept. of Education, Title III Biennial Report (SY 2020–22); Mantil et al. (2023, 2026); U.S. State Dept., FY2025 admissions report; UNHCR, Global Trends 2025.

WHAT WE HEARD

5+ HOURS

across three weeks, on one Arabic transcript for a 10th-grade Syrian student.



1 Generic tools

Staff rely on informal Google searches or unstandardized translation tools.

2 Letters from scratch

Every case gets a custom letter for the district and the family.

3 Fear of a wrong grade

Staff delay recommendations while they wait for the district to respond.

THE INSIGHT

Staff wait because no recommendation comes with *proof*.

So Paso's job is to make every recommendation one a case manager can stand behind, and to deliver it fast.



INTRODUCING

PASO

A starting-point plan, with proof on every line.

Upload a student's records. Paso reads them, checks skills, and a trained reviewer signs a plan the family understands and the school can trust.

Reads any record

Checks real skills

Signed by a person

In the family's language



HOW IT WORKS · FULL DEMO

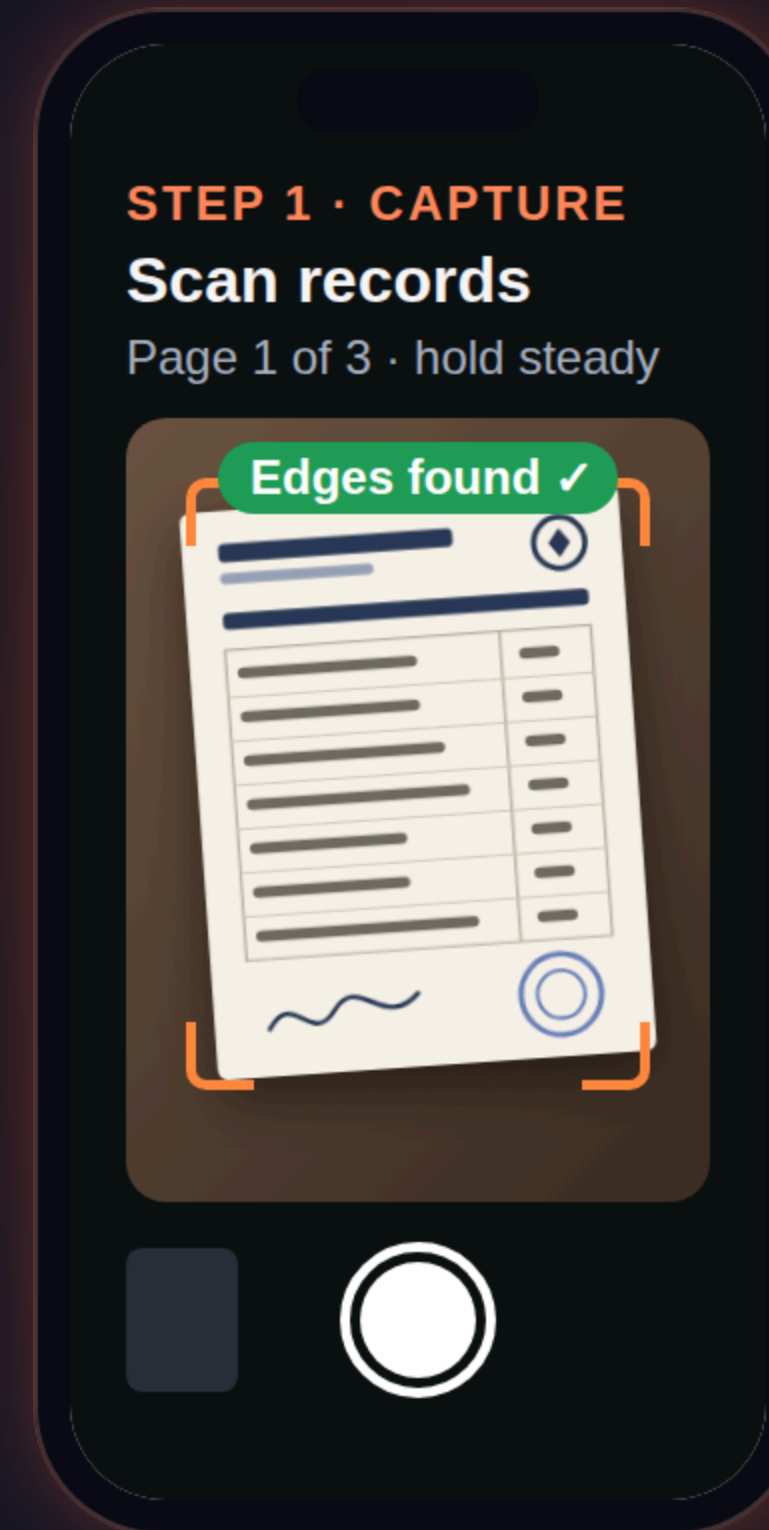
FROM PHOTO TO PLAN.

Ana's case, start to finish: a phone photo of her transcript becomes a signed plan in her family's language.

- 1 Snap three pages; Paso finds the edges
- 2 AI reads the photo and drafts course matches
- 3 Skills check, reviewer sign-off, family plan

Target: 3 business days, end to end

Demo · sample data



ANA'S CASE

01

Upload

Phone photo

02

Read

AI drafts matches

03

Check

Student

04

Review

Bilingual reviewer

05

Plan

Family and school

USER FLOW

FIVE STEPS. ONE SIGNED PLAN.



01

UPLOAD

Case manager

Phone photos of any transcript, in any language.



02

READ

Paso AI

Drafts course matches and flags anything unclear.



03

CHECK

Student

A short skills check in their own language.



04

REVIEW

Bilingual reviewer

Checks every line, then signs the plan.



05

PLAN

Family and school

A one-page plan for the family; the proof for the school.

Target: 3 business days, upload to signed plan

Never asks for immigration status

HOW IT WORKS · STEP 1 OF 5

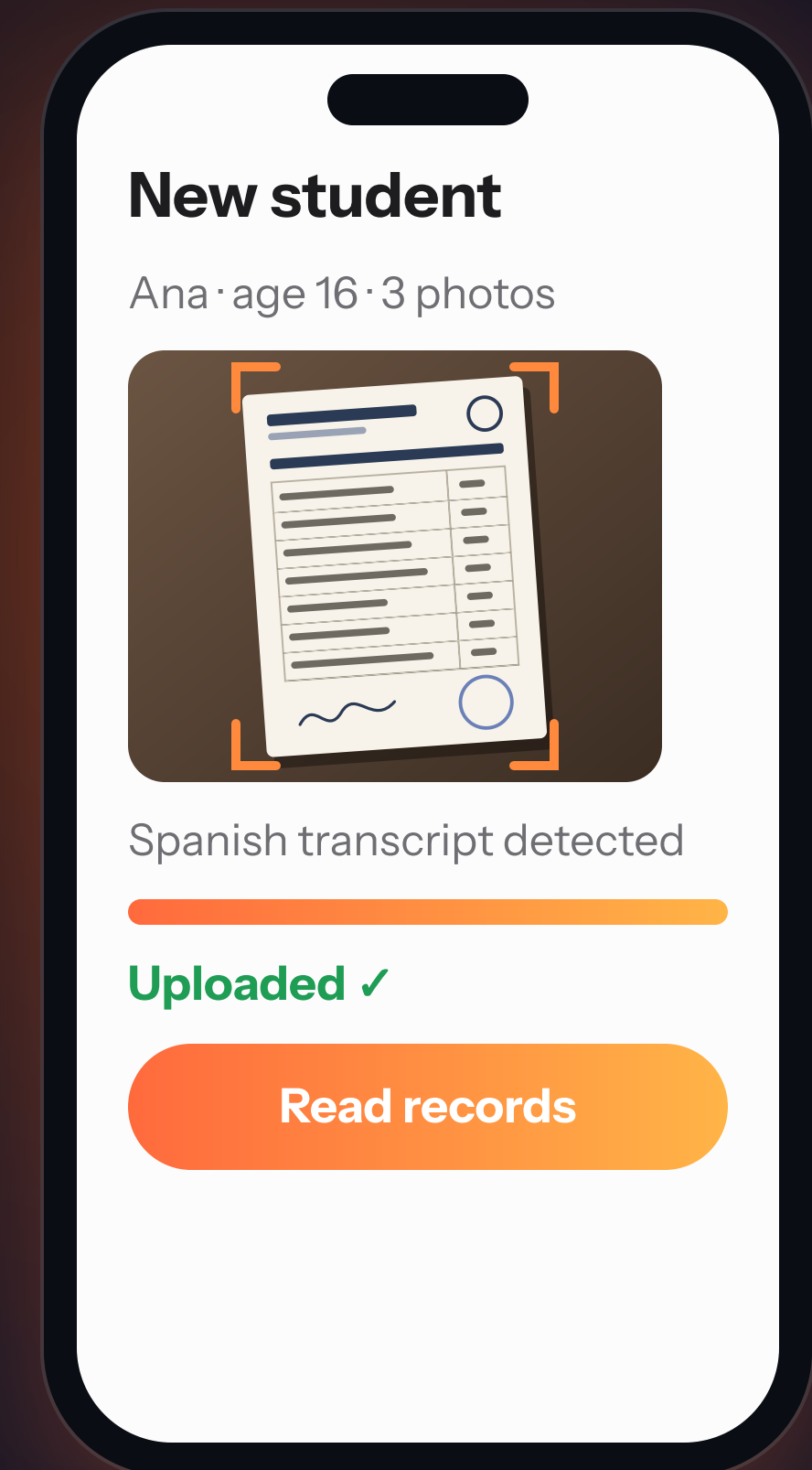
01 UPLOAD

A case manager snaps the transcript on a phone.

- Any language, any format: a phone photo is enough
- Paso finds the page edges and reads every page
- Never asks for immigration status

Who: Case manager

Prototype screens · Sample data · Ana is a composite



HOW IT WORKS · STEP 2 OF 5

02 READ

AI reads the record and drafts a match for every course.

- Matches each course to local courses and credits
- Flags anything it isn't sure of
- A draft only: a person decides

Who: Paso AI

Course matches

AI draft · 4 courses

Matemática III

Algebra 1

High

Ciencias Naturales

Physical Science

High

Idioma Español

Spanish

Exam

Estudios Sociales

World History

Flag

Flags go to the skills check.

HOW IT WORKS · STEP 3 OF 5

03 CHECK

A short skills check confirms what the record can't.

- In the student's own language
- Aimed at the gaps the record leaves
- Turns a guess into evidence

Who: Student

Math check

Question 4 of 12 · Español

Resuelve:

$$2x + 5 = 17$$

$x = 6$



$x = 11$

$x = 7$

Siguiente

HOW IT WORKS · STEP 4 OF 5

04 REVIEW

A trained reviewer checks every line, then signs.

- Every match shows its proof
- Each approval grows the course map
- A person is accountable for every plan

Who: Bilingual reviewer

Reviewer check

Ana · 4 matches · 1 flag

Algebra 1 ✓

Physical Science ✓

Spanish · by exam ✓

World History · 0.5 ✓

SIGNED

Trained bilingual reviewer

HOW IT WORKS · STEP 5 OF 5

05 PLAN

The family gets a plan in their language. The school gets the proof.

- One page, in plain language
- Shared by text message or on paper
- A proof sheet for the district

Who: Family and school

PLAN DE INICIO

Ana

Empieza en

GRADO 10

4.5 créditos reconocidos

Próximo paso: Lleve este plan a la reunión de inscripción.

Compartir con la familia

ES · EN · AR

THE OUTPUT

EVERY LINE CARRIES ITS PROOF.

Ana's starting-point plan

Grade 10 · 4.5 credits

Prior course	Matches	Credit	Proof
Mathematics (yr 3)	Algebra 1	1.0	Record + skills check
Natural Science	Physical Science	1.0	Record
Spanish Language	World Language: Spanish	2.0	Credit by exam
Social Studies	World History	0.5	Record, partial

✓ Signed by a trained reviewer · Sample data

FAMILY VERSION

Plan de inicio de Ana

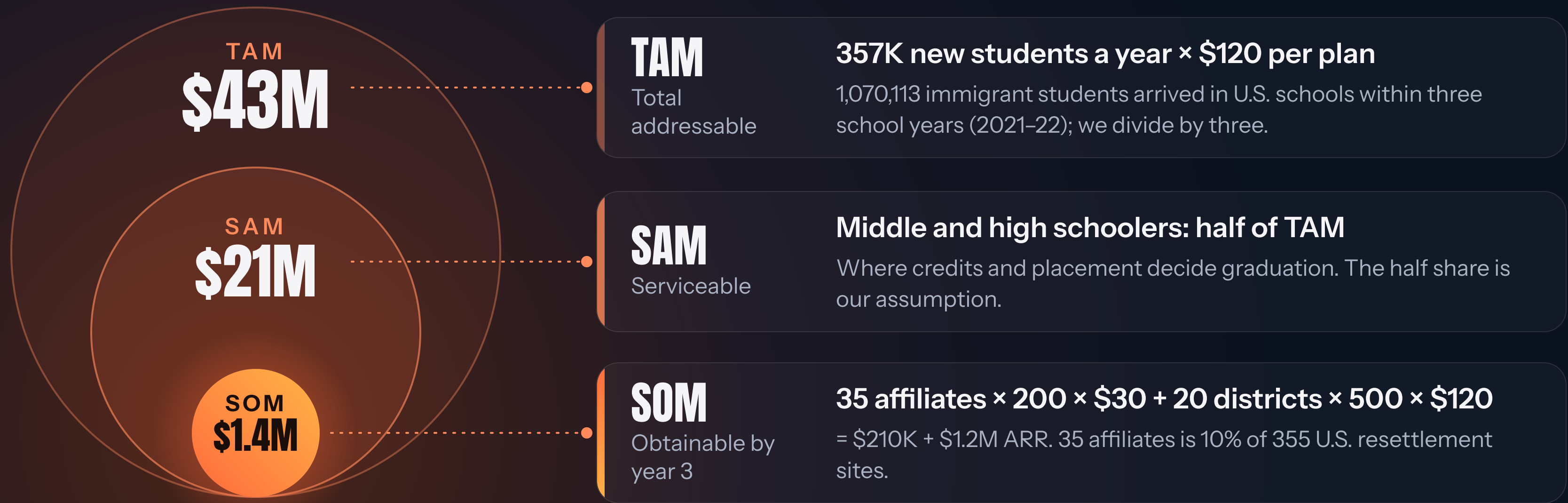
GRADO 10

Empieza en 10.º grado, con 4.5 créditos reconocidos.

Próximo paso: lleve este plan a la reunión de inscripción.

MARKET

A \$43M-A-YEAR U.S. MARKET TO START.



Headroom: 45M displaced children worldwide | **Risk:** refugee admissions 100,034 (FY24) → 10,258 (FY26, 10 mo.). Districts are channel two.

Paso estimates. Inputs, sources and assumptions are in the appendix.

METRICS

WHAT WE'LL
MEASURE.

NORTH STAR

Signed starting-point
plans

10 1,000

pilot

in 18 months

TIME TO PLAN

Target

2 WKS → 3 DAYS

upload to signed plan

STAFF PREP

Target

4 H → 2 H

per student, case manager time

FAMILY CLARITY

Target

80%+

can state grade and next course

DISTRICT ACCEPTANCE

Target

70%+

plans accepted as written

CREDITS RECOGNIZED

Tracked

PER STUDENT

vs. today's placement

GROSS MARGIN

Model

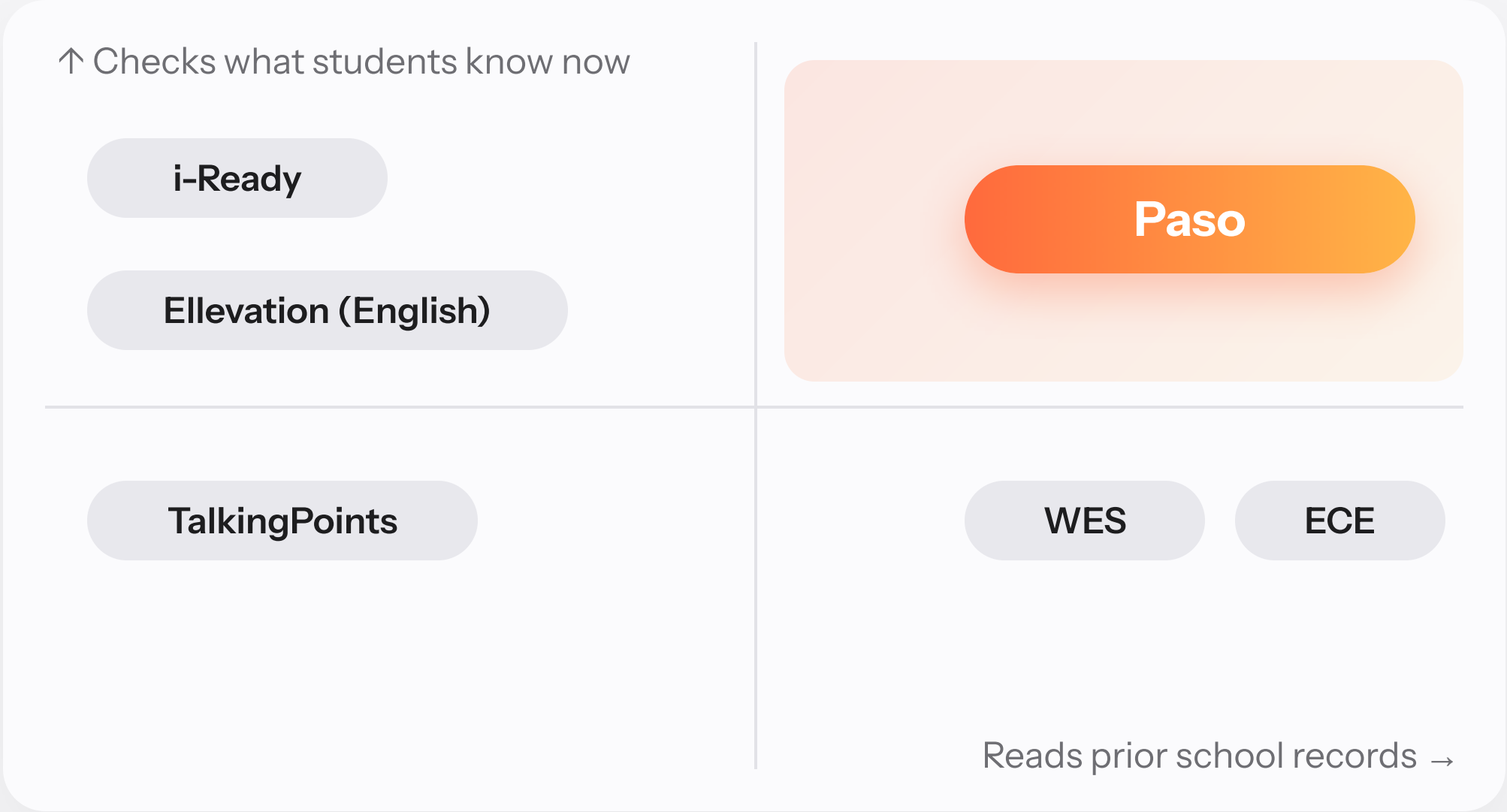
63% - 91%

at \$30 · at \$120 per plan

Targets are hypotheses from our MVP plan, not results. Margin is a model: reviewer ≈ \$10 + AI ≈ \$1 per plan.

COMPETITION

EVERYONE ELSE DOES HALF THE JOB.



WES, ECE

Read records, but stop at a U.S. equivalency, need official documents and take days to weeks.

i-Ready, Ellevation

Test students after enrollment, inside the district.

TalkingPoints

Translates messages, but doesn't evaluate.

Source: our competitive scan of each company's own website, October 2026.

OUR EDGE

EVERY PLAN MAKES THE NEXT ONE FASTER AND MORE TRUSTED.



A course map that compounds

Each reviewed match, like a year-3 math course from Guatemala to Algebra 1, is saved and reused.

Proof that schools accept

We track how often districts accept Paso plans. No competitor reports that number.

A channel no one serves

Sold to resettlement nonprofits; families never pay. Competitors sell to individuals or districts.

BUSINESS MODEL

NONPROFITS PAY. FAMILIES NEVER DO.

NOW · RESETTLEMENT
AFFILIATES

\$30

per student, from existing youth-services or case-management budgets. 200 students = \$6,000 a year.

NEXT · SCHOOL DISTRICTS

\$120

per plan, below WES (from \$186) and ECE (\$199) course-by-course reports.

UNIT ECONOMICS PER PLAN · MODEL

At \$30

63% gross margin



At \$120

91% gross margin



Cost per plan: reviewer time, 20 minutes at \$30 an hour (≈ \$10), plus AI (≈ \$1). We expect reviewer time to fall as the course map grows.

Prices, costs and margins are model assumptions we are testing, not results. WES and ECE prices from their own websites.

WHAT WE TEST NEXT

WE'LL PROVE IT BY HAND BEFORE WE BUILD IT.

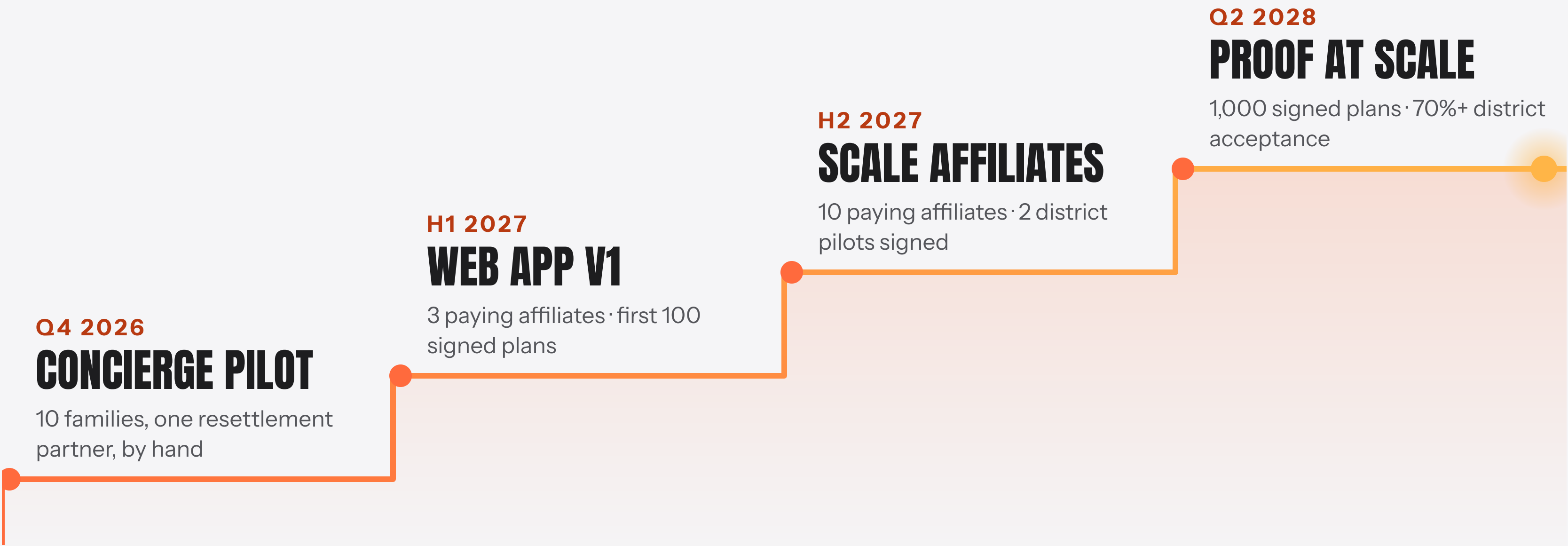
MVP 1: ten families with one resettlement partner, run with WhatsApp, Claude checked by a bilingual reviewer, Google Sheets, a paper skills check and a reviewer checklist.

Hypothesis	We believe	We're wrong if
H1·Need	Most families can't state their student's placement and next required course without help.	More than half of 8–10 families state both correctly.
H2·Cost	Each student takes at least 4 staff hours and 2 weeks today.	The median across 8–10 case managers is below either.
H3·Price	Affiliates will pay \$30 per student without a new grant.	Most budget holders can't name an approval path.

Early signal for H2: one transcript took 5+ hours across three weeks

ROADMAP

EIGHTEEN MONTHS. FOUR STEPS.



Milestones are plans and targets, not results.

THE ASK

WE'RE RAISING \$250K.

Pre-seed, on a post-money SAFE, to reach 1,000 signed plans in 18 months.

USE OF FUNDS



- **45%** Product: web app v1
- **30%** Pilots and bilingual reviewers
- **15%** Validation, privacy, compliance
- **10%** Go-to-market

MILESTONES IT BUYS

- 1,000** signed plans
- 10** paying affiliates
- 70%+** district acceptance
- 2** district pilots signed

From this room:

Resettlement affiliate directors

District multilingual-ed leads

Spanish and Arabic reviewers

APPENDIX

SOURCES AND ASSUMPTIONS

Mantil et al. (2023), Rising Numbers, Unmet Needs, Annenberg Institute at Brown: arrivals at 16+, 54% graduation, 1 in 6.

Mantil et al. (2026), Land of Opportunity?, Annenberg Institute at Brown: 64% vs. 16% in 9th grade; 38-point adjusted gap.

U.S. Dept. of Education (OELA), Title III Biennial Report, SY 2020–22: 1,070,113 immigrant students (2021–22).

UNHCR, Global Trends 2025: about 45M forcibly displaced children, end of 2025.

U.S. Dept. of State, FY2025 refugee admissions report: 355 local resettlement sites.

Pew Research Center (2026): 10,258 refugees admitted in FY2026's first 10 months. Williams Institute: 100,034 in FY2024.

Prices: WES Course-by-Course from \$186; ECE Course by Course \$199 (company websites, Oct 2026).

Our research: Mom Test interview with a youth education specialist at a resettlement affiliate; competitive scan, Oct 2026.

Assumptions: \$120 district price; SAM = half of TAM; 10% of affiliates; 200 students per affiliate, 500 per district; reviewer 20 min at \$30/h; AI ≈ \$1 per plan.

Notes: Ana is a composite. Screens are prototypes with sample data. Targets and margins are hypotheses, not results.